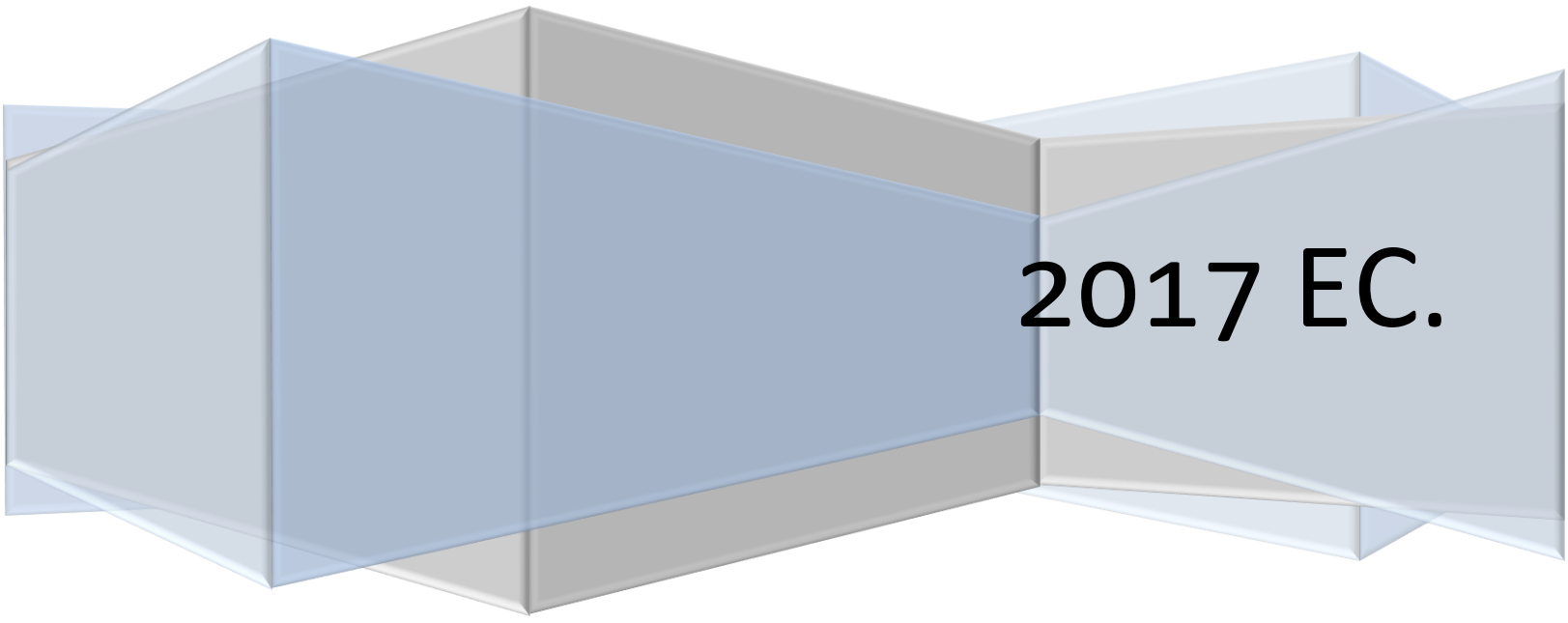
HOLY TRINITY UNIVERSITY

Theological Anthropology

By: Girma Batu



HOLY TRINITY UNIVERSITY

COURSE TITLE: THEOLOGICAL ANTHROPOLOGY

MHR. GIRMA BATU

Course Outline on "Theological Anthropology***"***

No.	**Items**	**Descriptions**
1.	Faculty	Fundamental Theology
2.	Department	Dogmatic Theology
3.	Subject/Course	Theological Anthropology
4.	Course code	
5.	Allotted years and Semester	One Semester
6.	Course Goals and Objectives	Based on the Genesis accounts of creation or the Biblical foundation of the doctrine, this course aims at uncovering the origin and destiny of the Human Person in Orthodox Theological Perspective.
7.	Course Description	The Human person is, essentially an exploration of some of the most relevant issues in theology. In addition, psychology, philosophy and other scientific fields concern with Anthropology. Theological Anthropology deals with the human person as revealed in the Holy Scriptures, Patristic, and other Liturgical sources as created in the Image and Likeness of God. This conception defends other social theories that consider the human being as evolved out of ape-like ancestors.
8.	Prerequisites	
9.	Language/s of learning, and evaluation	English
10.	Course Learning Objectives (CLO):	At the end of this course, students should be able to: a) Know an orthodox theological perspective on the Human Person b) Differentiate between Theological and scientific perceptions of the Human Person
11.	Methods used to Teach Course Objectives:	a) Weekly classes, Lectures and presentation (Q&A) b) Agenda focusing on the objective of the Course for discussion and case studies, c) Active participation in class
12.	Main Course Materials The course material consists of	a) Handouts and PowerPoint presentations, lecture notes and readings from the textbook. b) Material will be shared evenly and students are expected to create a system to share

		c) Textbook: A Handout prepared, **Additional Materials:** **Main References – Directly related**: • Mark Cortez, Christological Anthropology in Historical Perspective: Ancient and Contemporary Approaches to Theological Anthropology, 2016; • Vladimir Lossky, In the Image and Likeness of God, 1974; • Wolfhart Pannenberg, Anthropology in Theological Perspective, 1985; • ግርማ ባቱ፣ የነገረ መለኮት መግቢያ፣ 2014 ዓ.ም። **Additional References – indirectly related:** • Christopher G. Woznicki, T. F. Torrance's Christological Anthropology: Discerning Humanity in Christ, 2022; • James Beck & Bruce Demarest, The Human Person in Theology and Psychology: A Biblical Anthropology, 2005; • Jayson Brunelle, God and the Human Person, 2008; • Maximos Aghiorgoussis, In the Image of God,1999.
13.	Class Policies	a) Using a notebook, students are advised to take notes during lectures b) Homework will be assigned periodically. Reading from assigned chapters are expected c) Class attendance is mandatory; any absentee will be reported to the University d) Class discipline includes mature learning, physical appearance, attentiveness, e) Time punctuality, effective communications are parts of the class policy
14.	Course Assessment: Assignments Overview NB: Grading Scale is according to the Holy Trinity University	The students will be evaluated on the basis of their performance in the following assignments: ● Attendance 10% ● Midterm examination 30% ● Final examination 60% TOTAL 100%
15.	THE COURSE OUTLINE TO BE COVERED DURING THE SEMESTER ***Chapters and Sub Chapters***	Chapter One: Biblical Anthropology Chapter Two: Origin and Destiny in Theological Perspective Chapter Three: Human Person in Patristic Theological perspective Chapter Four: Theo-Anthropological Response to

		Contemporary Trends

Tentative Lesson Plan [14 weeks + Exam and evaluation time]

Weeks	Subject coverage	Activities
Week 1	Introduction	
Week 2	Biblical Anthropology: Man as Image and Likeness of God	
Week 3	The Constitutional Nature of Man (Dichotomy and Trichotomy views on the Human Person)	
Week 4	Origin and Destiny in Theological Perspective	
Week 5	Sin and the fall of Man	
Week 6	Restoration: Christological Anthropology	
Week 7	Mid Term Exam	30%
Week 8	Theology of the Image in Patristic Taught	
Week 9	"Eikon Theou" in Cappadocian Fathers	
Week 10	Purpose of the Human being in Theology	
Week 11	Dignity of the Human person in Patristic Thoughts	
Week 12	Sacramental Anthropology	
Week 13	Theo-Anthropological Response to Contemporary Trends	
Week 14	Summary and Conclusion	
Week 15	Final Exam	Evaluation 40-60 % + Attendance
Total Evaluation		**100%**

PART ONE

W1. Introduction

Theological Anthropology in Orthodox Christian Theology

The theological viewpoint of Anthropology is different from the philosophical, cultural, social viewpoints of Anthropology. The theological viewpoint refers to a knowledge which is unattainable naturally by the unassisted powers of reason, and is possible only through revelation to which man adheres by faith.[1]

Theology for the East is a means towards a mystical union with God. In Eastern Orthodox understanding, theology is not a study about God, but it is an aspect of mystical experience. Mystical experience or Mysticism cannot be taken as something completely different from theology, rather, mysticism is theology and theology is mysticism.

> "The Eastern Tradition has never made a sharp distinction between mysticism and theology; between personal experience of the divine mysteries and the dogma affirmed by the Church… To put it another way, we must live the dogma expressing a revealed truth, which appears to us as an profound mystery, in such a fashion that instead of assimilating the mystery to our mode of understanding, we should, on the contrary, look for a profound change, an inner transformation of the spirit, enabling us to experience it mystically…"[2]

This understanding of theology as a means towards an end, gives a different dimension, which enables us to perceive the human being from the origin to destiny.

The mystical theology of the Eastern orthodox churches, which is Apophatic in Approach, relies on Revelation of God Himself (Theophany) to have a little understanding on the divine *Energeia* of God. Revelation can be classified in to general and special. General revelation as a source of theology encompasses physical nature, **human nature**, and history. From this we can understand Theological Anthropology: 1. as a source of Orthodox Theology and, 2. as the primary locus of Orthodox Theology.

[1] C. Sumner, Philosophy of Man,
[2] Vladimir Lossky, The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Church, 1976, 8.

Theological Anthropology

Why it is important?

Here, it is better to refer to St. Basil of Caesarea in Hexaemeron:

"I see that for a long time you have been asking me for an account of the creation of man, and I Think I can hear you all cry in your hearts, we are being taught the nature of our belongings, but we are ignorant of ourselves. Let me then speak of it, **since it is necessary**, and let me put an end to my hesitation. **In truth the most difficult of sciences is to know one's self. ...**

We, Human beings, certainly want to know ourselves, we want to know about the meaning of life, we want to know our identity, our inner truth and our destiny. On the basis of this knowledge we desire and attempt to achieve our ultimate identity, to realize ourselves.[3]

Eastern Orthodox Theology asks "what is man" instead of "who is God". "What is man that you take thought of him and the son of man that you care for him" (Ps. 8:4). And answer is from God. "I said you are gods, and all of you are sons of the most high" (Ps. 82:6). God created man after his Image and Likeness (Genesis 1:27).

"The image of God is identified with a particular quality of the soul, its simplicity or its immortality, or else it is described as the ability of knowing God, of living in communion with Him, with the possibility of sharing the divine being or with the indwelling of the Holy Spirit in the soul"[4]

[3] Paul O'Callaghan, Children of God in the World: An Introduction to Theological Anthropology, 2016, 13.
[4] Vladimir Lossky, The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Church, 1976, 115.

ምንትኑ ይከብር እምዝንቱ መዓርግ ወዓይ ምክሕ የዓቢ እምኩሉ ትምክህት ከመ ይንብብ እግዚአብሔር በልሳነ ሊቀ ነቢያቲሁ ወይኩን ስምዐ ከመ ውእቱ ገብሮ ለእጓለ እመሕያው በአርአያሁ ወበአምሳሊሁ.[5]

"God created the human being as having control of everything on earth, and nothing on earth is greater than the human being, under whose authority everything falls"[6] Image is imprinted quality of the soul given by God. Likeness needs experience, commitment; trustworthiness ... Sin affected the likeness, not the image. Man doesn't ceased to be immortal, intelligent, speaker after the fall. But, man was not like God; humanity lost its likeness of God. "Nevertheless, man being in honor abideth not: he is like the beasts that perish" (Ps. 48(49):12).

The human person stands at the center of Christian reality. At the pinnacle of creation is its formation by the very hands of God. At the opposite pole, at the eschaton, the Christian Scriptures proclaim humanity's fulfillment and perfection. Along the way, between the poles of creation and fulfillment, the whole of the economy is focused on this being: that which God fashions, which turns against its creator, for which the creator works correction and redemption, even becoming that which he agrees to save.[7]

The doctrine of the human person holds a central position in Orthodox theology. How? The interrelation of humanity as 'The Image of God' to the church's developing articulation of its doctrine of God. Because, the chief anthropological doctrine of the church is one that defines humanity in terms of a reflection or image of the divine, it is only within the scope of an articulation of God that Christian anthropology can rightly be understood. And it is also in and through its anthropological considerations –that is, reflection on the Son of God as human- that this doctrine of the divine finds the grounds of its own articulation.

The doctrine of man can be seen as one of the areas in theology and also as the locus of each and every theological discussion. Christianity is as much anthropology as theology, for the anthropos and Theos of these categories are understood to meet in the single person of Jesus Christ. All theology should be understood as anthropology, because anthropology must be understood as

[5] ሃይማኖተ አበው ዘቅዱስ ጎርጎርዮስ ዘኑሲስ፣ ም. 36 ክፍል 4.
[6] The Fathers of the Church, St. John Chrysostom: Homily 1-17 (8), 1986, 110.
[7] Mathew C. Steenberg, Of God and Man: Theology as Anthropology from Irenaeus to Athanasius, 2009, 1.

theology. From the perspective of the incarnation or Christological Anthropology the two can never really be separate.[8]

This course is intended to bring some Orthodox doctrines and perspectives into discussion. The purpose is to show the dignity of the human Person, responsibilities, and destiny.

W2. CHAPTER ONE

Biblical Anthropology: Man as "Image and Likeness of God"

What the Bible teaches about the human being?

Any adequate reflection on the human person within the Christian tradition today must begin with consideration of the broader reality of creation. The Doctrine of creation bases its history on how God created the universe for human beings. The creation of man specifically concerned about how humanity is created uniquely after the image and likeness of God. The theology of the Image by itself needs a critical look: how it divides East and West, its relation with the doctrine of Holy Trinity, its promise to the likeness of God-Theosis.[9]

"Traditionally Christian theology has considered the transition from the discussion of nature to humanity as a disjuncture with the intention to underscore the importance of difference of humanity from the rest of creation. Contemporary theology, on the contrary, considers the transition just that, namely, transition, starting with the question of "what links human beings with animals and all other creatures."[10]

The Genesis story of creation placed man on the highest stair. After all the creation of the earth had been created, God said, "let Us make man in our image, after Our Likeness; and let him have dominion over the fish of the sea and over the fowl of the air … and over all the earth … so God created man in His own image, in the image of God created He him (Gen. 1:26-27).

[8] Ibid.
[9] Vladimir Lossky, In the Image and Likeness of God, 1985, pp. 111-139.
[10] Veli-Matti Karkkainen, Creation and Humanity, 2015, 233.

- The counsel of God, which is not indicated at the creation of the earth and other creatures, clearly speaks of the fact that man was to be a special creation, distinct from the others, the highest, most perfect, on earth, having also a higher purpose in the world.
- The creation of man was an immediate act of God. When we consider other creations, God was saying: "Let the earth put forth grass … let the water swarm with swarms of living creatures". When we come to man's creation we find a simple statement: "and God created man". God used the pre-existing material in forming the body of man, but even this was excluded in the creation of the soul.
- The concept of man's high purpose and his special significance is emphasized yet more in the fact that the counsel of God ordained that man be created in God's image. With respect to man God said "Let's make man in our Image, after our Likeness. The creation of man stands out as something distinctive.
- Certain details of man's creation which are given in the second chapter of Genesis emphasize once more a special supremacy of human nature. "And God **formed man** from the dust of the earth, and **breathed into his nostrils the breath of life**; and man became a living soul (Gen 2:7).[11] This "spirited" living being, formed of ha adama (earth) is called Adam. A clear distinction was made between the origin of the body and the soul. This distinction is used in other parts of the Holy Bible like: "then shall the dust return to the earth as it was and the spirit shall return unto God who gave it" (Ecclesiastes 12:7). "And fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather fear him who is able to destroy both soul and body in the hell" (Matt. 10:28).
- Man is at once placed in a dignified position. Man is represented as standing at the apex of all the created orders. He is crowned as king of the lower creation, and is given dominion over all the inferior creatures. As such it was his duty and privilege to make all nature and all the created beings that were placed under his rule, subservient to his will and purpose, in order that he and his whole glorious dominion might magnify the almighty creator and Lord of the universe, Gen. 1:28; Ps. 8:4-9.[12]

[11] Michael Pomazansky, Orthodox Dogmatic Theology, 2015, 123-142.
[12] Louis Berkhof, Systematic Theology, 2000, pp. 182-183.

W. 3. The Constitutional Nature of Human

How we view man's makeup is of considerable importance. In considering the makeup of man, we must be particularly careful to examine the presuppositions we bring to our study. Because there are non-Biblical disciplines which also are concerned about man, the possibility that some of their conceptions might affect our theological constructions. Whether it is an ancient Greek dualism or a modern behavioristic monism, we need to be on guard against mixing a non-Biblical presupposition into our understanding of Scripture.[13]

Basic views of the Human Constituents

Trichotomism

In Trichotomism: A human is composed of three elements: body, soul and spirit. According to Millard Ericson, this view is popular in protestant circles.[14] In this view man is composed of three elements: the first element is the physical body, something human have in common with animals and plants but it is different in degree. The second part of the human is the soul. According to this view, the soul is the psychological element, the basis of reason, emotion and social interrelatedness. In Trichotomy, what distinguishes the humans from the animals is not a more complex and advanced soul, but a third element, namely, a spirit. This religious element enables humans to perceive spiritual matters and respond to spiritual stimuli. It is the seat of spiritual qualities of the individual, whereas personalities traits are reside in the soul.

Body: from the Greek soma, it is the corporeal or physical aspect of the human being.
Soul: from the Hebrew Nephesh, Nepes means "breath" or "breathing being". This word usually designates the whole human person. In the Septuagint nepes is mostly translated as "psyche".
Spirit: The spirit (Hebrew ruach, Greek πνεῦμα, pneuma, which can also mean "breath") is likewise an immaterial component. It is often used interchangeably with "soul", psyche, although trichotomists believe that the spirit is distinct from the soul.

[13] Millard Erickson, Christian Theology, 1985, 520.
[14] Christian Theology, Third Edition, 2013, 477.

The major foundation of Trichotomism is certain scriptural passages that either enumerate three components of the human nature or distinguish between soul and spirit. Some examples are mentioned below:

Gen. 2:7 "Then God formed man out of dust from the ground, and breathed in his face the breath of life; and man became a living soul."

Trichotomists enumerate the dust of the ground as Body, the breath of life as spirit and living soul itself as the third element in man. But the verse can be translated as "the breath of life is the grace of the Holy Spirit, the giver of life (the creed). God breathed the breath of life into man's body, and he became a living soul. Therefore Adam was a living soul because he possessed a body, a soul and the grace of the Holy Spirit."[15]

"In the same way that Irenaeus carefully distinguished between man, whose parts are the body and soul and the life in which he participates (**AH 2. 34)** so too the Spirit must not be thought of as a 'part' (Constitution) of man."[16]

"ወነፍሐ በገጹ (ውስተ ገጹ) መንፈሰ ሕይወት ማለት፣ ሕይወት የምትሆነው ነፍስን አሳደረበት፣ አንድም የጸጋ ሕይወት የሚሆነው መንፈስ ቅዱስን አሳደረበት፣ አዳምም ሕይወት በምትሆን ነፍስ ሕያው ባለአእምሮ ሆነ"[17]

St. Gregory of Nazianzus teaches that *"The soul is the breath of God, and while being heavenly, it endures being mixed with what is of the dust. … Having taken a part of the newly created earth, with his immortal hands formed my image and imparted to it His life; because He sent into it the Spirit, which is a ray of the invincible Divinity"*[18].

"የእግዚአብሔር ልጆች መሆናችንን ያ መንፈስ ራሱ **ከመንፈሳችን** ጋር ይመሰክራል" (ሮሜ 8፡16)። ይህንም የቤተ ክርስቲያን ሊቃውንት ውእቱ መንፈስ ቅዱስ ሰማዕቱ ለመንፈስነ ከመ ውሉደ እግዚአብሔር

[15] The Orthodox Study Bible, 2008, 5.
[16] John Behr, Asceticism and Anthropology in Irenaeus and Clement, Published to Oxford Scholarship Online: October 2011 (http://www.oxfordscholarship.com.ezproxy.apollolibrary.com/view/10)
[17] መጻሕፍተ ብሉያት ፪ቱ፣ (ትንሣኤ ማሳተሚያ ድርጅት) 1999 ዓ.ም፣ 22.
[18] Gregory of Nazianzus, Homily 7, "On the Soul".

ንሕነ - **የእግዚአብሔር ልጆች እንደኾንን ለልቡናችን ምስክሩ መንፈስ ቅዱስ ነው በማለት ይመልሱታል**። ቅዱስ ዮሐንስ አፈወርቅም በጥምቀት ምክንያት ባገኘነው ልጅነት በእኛ የሚሠራው የመንፈስ ቅዱስ ጸጋ መንፈሳችን ተብሎ እንደተገለጸ አስተምሮበታል።[19]

"May God Himself, the God of peace, sanctify you wholly; and I pray God your whole **spirit, soul, and body** be kept blameless unto the coming of our lord Jesus Christ" (1Thessolonians 5:23). +

"በሥጋ በነፍስ በደመ ነፍስ ሕያዋን ያድርጋችሁ"[20]

"For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of **soul and spirit**, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart" (Hebrew 4:12, 1 cor. 2:14; 1Cor. 15:44)

Some Greek Philosophers taught that the body is the material aspect of man, the soul is the immaterial aspect, and the spirit brings the two into relationship with one another.[21]

Trichotomism became popular with clement of Alexandria and Origen. It fell into a certain amount of dispute after Apollinarius made use of it in constructing his Christology, which the Church determined to be heretical.

Dichotomism: probably the most widely held view throughout most of the history of Christian taught has been the view that man is composed of two elements, a material aspect-the body, and immaterial component-the soul or spirit. In this understanding man is a union of Body and Soul.

አክሲማሮስ ዘኤጲፋንዮስ "ሰው ማለት ሰባት ባሕርያትን የያዘ ማለት ነው ፡ እነዚህም አራቱ ባሕርያተ ሥጋ ሦስቱ ግብራተ ነፍስ አንድ የሆኑበት ... **ዝኬ ውእቱ ሰብእ ነፍስ ወሥጋ ብሂል**። [ሰው ማለት ሥጋና ነፍስ

[19] The Complete Works of St. John Chrysostom: Homily 14 on Romans, (Romans 8:16); The Orthodox Study Bible: Ancient Christianity Speaks to Today's World, 2008, 1536 (Romans 8:14-17).
[20] የቅዱስ ጳውሎስ መጽሐፍ፡ ንባቡ ከነትርጓሜው፣ 1988 ዓ.ም. ገ. 344።
[21] Millard Erickson, Christian Theology Third Edition, 2013, 477.

ያለው/የተዋሐዱበት ማለት ነው] አንድም ሰብእ ማለት አራቱ ባሕርያተ ሥጋ ሦስቱ ባሕርያተ ነፍስ እነዚህ ሰባት ባሕርያት የአሉበት ማለት ነው" ይላል።[22]

The Biblical concept of man avoids dualism, platonic, Neo-Platonic or Cartesian according to which the body is a substance different from the soul. In the Biblical synthetic perspective, the Body-Soul dualism is absent.[23] The prevailing representation of the nature of man in scripture is clearly dichotomic.[24]

In a dichotomist view, we sometimes observe that soul and spirit are interchangeably used. For example Mathew 27:50 says: "Jesus when He had cried again with a loud voice, Yielded up His spirit - ኢየሱስም ሁለተኛ በታላቅ ድምጽ ጮኾ **ነፍሱን** ተወ". St. Yared interpreted this verse as "ጊዜ ተስዓቱ ሰዓት ገዓረ ኢየሱስ በቃሉ ወወጽአት **መንፈሱ** ሶቤሃ"

For Dichotomists, those scriptural verses like 1 Thess. 5:23 must be seen contextually. For example, in Luke 10:27 the Lord Christ said, "Love your God with all your heart and with all your soul, and with all your strength and with your entire mind." Here, we have four entities that do not match the three in 1 Thess. 5:23.

Ecclesiastics 3:21 "who knows the **spirit** of man that goes upward, and that the **spirit** of the beast that goes downward to the earth?" (የሰው ልጆች **ነፍስ** ወደ ላይ እንደምትወጣ የእንስሳም ነፍስ ወደታች ወደምድር እንደምትወርድ የሚያውቅ ማነው?) The Hebrew word here for the spirit is *Ruach.* The terms "spirit" and "soul" often seem to be used interchangeably. For example, Luke 1:46-47:

"My soul glorifies the Lord and my spirit rejoices in God my Savior." This is parallelism, when the two terms seem virtually equivalent.

ወትቤ ማርያም ተዓብዮ ነፍስየ ለእግዚአብሔር - እመቤታችንም ሰውነቴ እግዚአብሔርን ታከብረዋለች። ወትትሐሰይ መንፈስየ በአምላኪየ ወመድኃኒየ - ልቡናየም በፈጣሪዬ በመድኃኒቴ አምና ደስ ይላታል። [25]

[22] መጽሐፈ አክሲማሮስ ዘቅዱስ ኤጲፋንዮስ፣ (አዘጋጅና አሳታሚ አባ ሠና ምስክር) 2002 ዓ.ም.፣ 149-151፤ በአማን ነጸረ፣ ወልታ ጽድቅ፣ 2009 ዓ.ም.፣ ገ. 134።

[23] Claude Sumner, Philosophy of Man Vol I, 1989, 57.

[24] Louis Berkhof, Systematic Theology, 2000, 192.

[25] ወንጌል ቅዱስ፡ ንባቡ ከነ ትርጓሜው፣ 1988 ዓ.ም. 374 (ሉቃስ 1፡46-47)።

In Mathew 10:28 we find, "And fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather fear him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell. In this case, the basic components of human are body and soul.

The spiritual principle in man which is opposed to the body is designated in sacred scripture by two terms which are almost equal in significance: "spirit" and "soul."[26]

The statement that the soul is heavenly origin doesn't mean that the soul is Divine in Essence; rather it means "the soul is helped by something greater than itself. It is the presence of this divine power in it … which is grace."[27]

Wisdom 9.15: "For a perishable body weighs down the soul and this earthy tent burdens the thoughtful mind." By our composition, Gregory means humanity's composite nature, our being made up of body and soul.[28]

Irenaeus of Lyon identifies the soul with the 'breath of life' recounted in Genesis 2.7, the force by which the dust becomes a living being. It is a gift directly from God, an actualizing (Irenaeus' preferred term is 'vivifying') power, reflecting or transmitting his own divine attributes, for it is incorporeal and immortal, each of which are attributes of God alone. This soul, through union with the body, brings the 'thing molded' – the flesh wrought of the dust – from inanimacy to life. Irenaeus' intention is to show that the soul, thus defined as properly incorporeal and immortal. The two – body and soul – are one in the actualization of human personal reality. Irenaeus' peculiar language of the soul's 'shape', of its relation in 'velocity' to the body, is meant above all to demonstrate the intimacy of their union.[29]

In the words of Behr, 'the Spirit is essential to Irenaeus' understanding of man, yet is not a "part" of his constitution [. . .] The Spirit itself is not a man, nor even a part of a man, but is itself given to man in such a manner that it can be legitimately described as his Spirit'. Categories of 'bi-partite' and 'tri-partite', which scholars of theological anthropology often assign to a given author's perception of the human creature, are challenged by Irenaeus' reading. The human person is two 'parts' in composition (body and soul), yet three in actualization (body, soul and

[26] Michael Pomazansky, Orthodox Dogmatic Theology. 2015, 135-137.
[27] Vladimir Lossky, The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Church, 1976, 118.
[28] Gregory of Nazianzus Five Theological Orations (Translated with an introduction and notes by Stephen Reynolds, 2011), 16.
[29] M.C. Stenbeerg, Of God and Man: Theology as Anthropology from Irenaeus to Athanasius, 2009, 39.

Spirit). Already in its formation it is both material and immaterial, but this composite being of body and soul has life – true and full life – only when these exist in communion with the vivifying Spirit of the Father.[30]

For the human person to be created in the image of this God is for it to be a material being fashioned of dust, joined to the divine life. 'Man is a living being composed of a soul and a body', Irenaeus writes, but this composition is genuinely alive only when the soul communicates to the body the life of the Holy Spirit. The human person is thus a dynamic being in its ontological fabric, vivified through a communion with God that grows over time, until in the incarnation it is brought fully to the divine life. As such, the nature of human existence is one of development into the unfolding economy through which this communion is enabled and made real, both for the one race of humanity as a whole, and in the individual life of each human person.[31]

The common thing between Trichotomism and Dichotomism views exceed their differences. They both agree that man is complex or compound that is made up of separable parts.

Monism

This view says that man is indivisible**.** Monism insists that man is not to be thought of as in any sense composed of parts or separate entities, but rather as a radical unity. When you divide the constituents each must have independent existence.

Week 4

Origin of Man **in Theological Perspective**

Origin of man and the rest of the created world are among major issues in theology, philosophy and other social sciences. As we have already discussed earlier, man is created after the image and likeness of God (Gen. 1:26). Other perspectives see the human person as an offshoot of evolutionary process or an evolved one.

The Orthodox Church's article of faith says: "I believe in one Cod, Father Almighty, Creator of heaven and earth, of all things visible and invisible." Reference to creation was added because

[30] M.C. Stenbeerg, Of God and Man: Theology as Anthropology from Irenaeus to Athanasius, 2009, 40-41.
[31] M.C. Stenbeerg, Of God and Man: Theology as Anthropology from Irenaeus to Athanasius, 2009, 52.

the Church had to show how the Christian doctrine of creation was distinct from other views of the cosmos. As usual, we not only have to say how the doctrine came to be articulated, but also what its significance is for us today.

Gnosticism denied that God was directly responsible for the creation of this world. Instead, the world was the creation of another being, which it called not 'God' but simply the 'Creator', the lowest of the eons that made up a long hierarchy that separated God from the world.

The Church declared that the very opposite was true: it was God himself who had created the world. The Church declared in its creed that the one God, the Father Almighty, was 'Creator of all things visible and invisible' The Father, God himself, is the Creator.

The Church responded to Gnosticism by saying that the relationship that God has with the world is direct and immediate.[32]

Gnosticism says man is created by both the creators of spiritual and physical world. Not only Gnosticism, but there are different and many perspectives on the origin of man that contradict the teaching of the church. The Orthodox theology firmly teaches that man is created by the one and only God at the end of creation.

This is a fundamental difference between Christianity and the philosophical and gnostic systems of the period when the Christian doctrine of creation was being articulated. Gnostic systems begin with the creation of man and end with the creation of matter and other inferior beings, believing that creation began with higher beings and that all subsequent movement represent deterioration into inferior and more material forms of being. But in the biblical view' we find no such contempt for the material world. The appearance of man at the end of creation indicates that man is the highest of all creatures and that God intended the material world for him. He is the creature who is to bring the entire material world into communion with God.

The position of man at the end of creation also points to his exercise of freedom on behalf of the material world. Because he is created with freedom, man may set himself for the world or against it. He can either receive it as good, or he can decide that he does not want to receive it at all.

The biggest scientific challenge – and resource – for contemporary theological anthropology is evolutionary theory. The relation of Christians to Darwinism has taken a long and winding road,

[32] John D. Zizioulas, Lectures in Dogmatics, 2008, 83.

from acceptance in the beginning years, to opposition, to finally an embrace of its theistic form by mainline Christianity – notwithstanding continuing opposition among conservative churches.[33]

Leading Rabbis of both the Nineteenth century and traditional communities in the United States vehemently opposed evolution while the famous Italian Kabbalist[34] Eliyahu Benamozegh (d. 1900) considered evolution as fully compatible with Judaism. Contemporary western theologians nowadays also see no conflict with the theistic interpretation of Darwinism.

> Evolutionary theory has been around for generations, but in recent years two factors are bringing the issue back into the public eyes. The first is the relentless, articulate, and popular attacks on Christianity by the new atheists. Others have aggressively promoted evolution and argued that Evolution has destroyed the possibility of religious faith, especially a faith like Christianity, whose sacred writings contain the story of Adam, the first man created out of dust several thousand years ago.[35]

The impact of evolutionary theory on the religious attitude of countries, including Ethiopia is so immense.

Discuss your observations on Ethiopian Curriculum in general and subjects in particular.

> "Modern anthropology no longer follows Christian tradition in defining the uniqueness of humanity explicitly in terms of God; rather, it defines this uniqueness through reflection on the place of humanity in nature and specifically through a comparison of human existence with that of the higher animals. To some extent this represents a revival of the ancient and in particular the Stoic approach which understood humanity in the framework of the cosmic order as a microcosm that reflects the macrocosm of the physical universe. Democritus was the first to describe the human being as "a world in miniature," a microcosm (Diels, Frag. 34).[36]

From a theological point of view, the nature of man is emphasized both as the continuity of with the natural world, and our transcendent from it. Off course, there has been more emphasis on

[33] Veli-Matti Karkkainen, Creation and Humanity vol. 3, 2015, 235.
[34] Kabbalists are students or practitioners of Kabbalah, a mystical and esoteric interpretation of the Jewish religion. The word "Kabbalah" comes from the Hebrew word for "reception" or "tradition," and it explores the nature of God, the creation of the universe, and the human soul through deeply symbolic and mystical teachings. Many Kabbalists study the Zohar, a foundational work in Kabbalistic thought.
[35] Peter Enns, The Evolution of Adam: What the Bible Does and Doesn't Say About Human Origins, 2012, IX_XIV.
[36] Wlfhart Pannenberg, Anthropology in a Theological Perspective, 1985, 27.

difference on our unique "Image of God" status, than our continuity with the natural world. In human beings both the natural and spiritual worlds meet, we are both natural and spiritual creatures, and in this sense stand at the center of creation.[37]

Concerning man's destiny we take up the concept of the 'image' from his/her origin, for man was created 'in the image and likeness of God' (Genesis 1.26). Though they display a range of views, the Fathers often suggest that 'in the image' expresses the perfect state of man at the beginning of creation, the way he was created by God, while 'in the likeness' refers to the state that man will achieve at the end of time, when he finally looks upon God face to face and the communion of created and uncreated is complete. This likeness is significantly related with the Image. Then, in the eschaton, man will also be 'likeness of God'. The final destination of man is Likeness of God or to be like God –Theosis-union with God.

The idea of man's union with God was present in several Greek philosophical schools such as Platonism and especially Stoicism, as well as in mystery-religions. **But union with God in those philosophies was perceived in a pantheistic manner.** In John's and Irenaeus' language, as well as in Greek patristic thought, salvation as union with God includes the total person body and soul. But this is not in a pantheistic manner which would mean likeness of the human with God.[38]

Week Five: Sin and Fall of Man

Sin, Hamartia in Greek is both extremely important and much disputed. The doctrine of sin affects and affected many other areas of theology. If God is transcendent, pure, and holy being, who expects all humans to be as He is. "You shall be holy: for I the Lord your God am holy" (Lev. 19:1-2). Therefore, the slightest deviation from this standard is sin and makes the human condition is serious.

Our understanding of humanity also bears on our understanding of sin. Also our doctrine of salvation is strongly influenced by our understanding of sin. One's understanding of sin is also important because it has a marked effect upon one's view of the nature. Sin destroys humans in

[37] Gregerson, etal. The Human Person in Science and Theology, 2000, 50.
[38] Demetrios J. Constantelos, Irenaeus of Lyon and His Central Views on Human Nature (St Vladimir's Theological Quarterly) 1989, 355.

that it breaks up the relationships that bind them to God, to one another, to themselves, and to creation as a whole. Thus the "sin factor" should be kept in mind at every stage throughout this study as a malignant power capable of destroying humans in every possible way, of dehumanizing them; at heart; in fact, the presence of sin is capable of deforming all anthropological reflection.[39]

From the beginning "The Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden' to till it and keep it. And the Lord God commanded the man saying, of every tree of the garden you may eat freely; but from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil you shall not eat, for in the day that you eat from it you will surely die" (Gen. 2:16 & 17).

According to St. John Chrysostom, to till and keep the garden means to believe in God, and to keep the commandments. And the tree of knowledge is a boundary to the inner region of paradise (St. Ephrem) and got its name before man broke God's commandment by touching it.

God gave man a place and law. The place was paradise and the law was the commandment given in Gen. 2:16-17. Man was to obey this commandment through the grace of God. If he was obedient, he would enjoy the blessings of the paradise. But if he were to disobey the commandment, he would die and his body would decay in the grave.[40]

Sin entered to the life of humans because of by disobeying God's commandment. The story in Genesis tells us that Adam and Eve decided to hear Satan instead of God and died.[41] Yet at the same time there is every indication that people remain "in God's Image" – that no harm has been done to this status or to the image on which it is based.

Sin and Satan's presence and even control are realities. Irenaeus was the one to emphasize Adam's fall and identify sin with *apostasia* or rebellion against God. Even though Adam's disobedience introduced sin and brought man under the influence of Satan, the divine Image of man was not totally destroyed. When man was released from Satan's control, he regained the possibility of immortality and recovered his divine likeness by the perfect obedience of Christ.

[39] Paul O'Callaghan, Children of God in the World: An Introduction to Theological Anthropology, 2016, 4.
[40] The Orthodox Study Bible, 2008, 6. (Gen. 2:8-17)
[41] St. Ephrem the Syrian, Commentary on Genesis (2:23) 115.

"For as by one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so also by one Man's obedience many will be made righteous." (Rom 5:19)

The work of Christ was a work of recapitulation and restoration. Irenaeus writes:

> "Christ recapitulated in himself the ancient formation. For whereas through the disobedience of one man sin entered, and death through sin, so also through the obedience of one man righteousness was introduced and will give life to those men who were once dead. And whereas that Adam, had his substance from untilled and as yet virgin soil … so he who is the Logos, recapitulating Adam in Himself, rightly received from Mary, who is a virgin, a birth which was a counterpart of Adam." [42]

Since image is about spiritual connection with God, people retain this connection though their relationship with God is badly damaged. And God still intends for people to reflect likeness to Him though in actuality they largely fail to do so. The image of God is the standard of which people are created to be and that standard is not diminished in any way because of sin.[43]

Sin affected the likeness of God in Man, for this reason the Psalmist said *"But man in his pomp will not endure; He is like the beasts that perish" (Ps 48/49:12).*

A very important Biblical verse is to be found in Gen.9:6 saying, "Whoever sheds man's blood; by man his blood shall be shed. For in the image of God He made man". This is an indication that the image is not damaged by the fall and the Holy Bible is affirming the fact. We also find the Epistle of James in the New Testament affirming, "With it we bless our God and Father, and with it we curse men, who have been made in the similitude of God".

The Fall of Man

Man's first sin consisted in his eating of the tree of knowledge of good and bad. The reason why it is named after this name is because the eating of it would impart a practical knowledge of good and evil.

Adam placed himself in opposition to God that he refused to subject his will to the will of God. As a result:

- Spiritual depravity of human nature (spiritual inability) "Then the Lord saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that all intent of the thoughts of his heart

[42] St. Vladimir's Theological Quarterly, 1989, 360.
[43] John F. Kilner, Dignity and Destiny: Humanity in the Image of God, 2015, 134.

was only evil continually." (Gen 6:5). "They have all turned aside, they have together become corrupt; There is none who does good, No, not one." Ps 14:3

- Loss of communion with God through the Holy Spirit (Eph. 2:1;)
- Physical death resulted from the first sin of man (Gen. 3:19). "Therefore, just as through one man sin entered the world, and death through sin, and thus death spread to all men, because all sinned" (Rom 5:12).

1. Humanity, created in the image of God, is loved by God. There is one human nature. All individual human beings participate in this universal.
2. But human nature has surrendered to the power of death. Death is not a positive quality but a privation of being.
3. To rescue humanity from its plight, God needs to retrieve human beings from the state of death.
4. In Christ, God becomes incarnate; the divine nature is united with human nature. Exactly how this union occurs is unknowable.
5. What happens to human nature in Christ happens to humanity as a whole because of Nature. (The universal effect)
6. Human nature is now freed from the power of death and is restored to its created position. (The Solution)
7. Human nature is now united to God and receives the benefits far surpassing its created position. (The Surplus)[44]

Week Six

Restoration; Christological Anthropology

Christological Anthropology:

What is to be human in Christianity?

The orthodox theologians focus the role of Christology in theological anthropology. Other major thinkers have made Jesus Christ the key to being human. Christian understanding of what is to be

[44] Christopher G. Woznicki, T. F. Torrance's Christological Anthropology, 2022, 51.

human unfolds through shared engagement and meditation in the community of faith ... A fuller theological account of who and what we are as humans emerges from the church's prayerful engagement with each of these realms as we keep the person of Jesus Christ in focus.

Jesus Christ is fully and truly human, a central claim of Orthodox Christology, without making the further claim that His humanity somehow reveals or determines something about the nature of humanity in general. He is "the true image of our humanity" we only understand "what we are as humans" if we keep the person of Jesus in locus. This is the Christ-centered lens through which we must look if we want to see what it really means to be human.[45]
Consequently, "the Christian understanding of true humanity is rooted in reflection on the person of Jesus Christ. The fundamental intuition of Christian anthropology is not merely the important truth that Jesus Christ is human but the corresponding epistemological affirmation that He reveals true humanity.

The Concept of Person

Theological definitions of persons are more like the doctrine of atonement than Christology. There is no single agreed upon ecumenical definition of what a person is, rather, there are a number of conceptual families with distinct ways of describing what it means to be a person. The most well-known and probably the most historically significant definition of personhood got its origin in the sixth century Roman statesman and philosopher Boethius[46], who defined persons as "*naturae rationalis inidividua substantia."*[47] This definition of a person as an *individual substance of a rational nature* gets picked up by and cemented into the Christian tradition, mostly in the west.

[45] Marc Cortez, Christological Anthropology in Historical Perspective: Ancient and Contemporary Approaches to Theological Anthropology, 2016.
[46] Boethius, full name Anicius Manlius Severinus Boethius, was a Roman philosopher, scholar, and statesman who lived from around 480 to 524 AD. He is best known for his work "The Consolation of Philosophy", written while he was imprisoned. This work explores themes of fortune, suffering, and happiness, and one of the most influential texts of the middle ages.
[47] Boethius used this definition in his work "Contra Eutychen et Nestorium" to articulate the nature of Christ and the Holy Trinity. By defining a person as an individual substance with rational nature, [as a catholic] he aimed to clarify the distinction between the divine and human natures of Christ, as well as the unity and distinction within the Trinity.

In recent years, however, a new conceptual frame has developed: "Relational Ontologies". Relational ontologies, as the term indicates, hold to the view that **personhood is relational**. This does not simply mean that relations are fundamental to flourishing as persons; rather, it means that in some sense **persons only become persons through relations with other persons**.

John Zizioulas, for example, says that personhood never occurs in an individualistic manner; it is always a gift from some other person. Thus, a person "is an 'I' that can exist only as long as it relates to a 'thou' which affirms its existence and its otherness." In other words, a "person is otherness in communion and communion in otherness."[48]

John Zizioulas discussed "Personhood in the Light of Christology and Pneumatology" with human capacity and incapacity. For him "the mystery of man reveals itself fully only in the light of Christ."[49]

- Christology should not be confined to redemption from sin but reaches beyond that, to man's destiny as the Image of God in creation. There are, therefore, two aspects of Christology, one negative (redemption from the fallen state) and another positive (Fulfillment of Man's full Communion with God; what the Greek fathers have called theosis. Only if the two are taken together, can Christology reveal human destiny in its fullness.
- If we recapture the existential content of the fall, sin reveals itself not in the form of a juridical relationship between God and man, but mainly as a perversion of personhood, leading through man's idolatrous introversion towards created being alone, to the opening up of the abyss of nothingness, that is the division between the two natures, divine and human, which were meant to be in communion, and hence to death because of the incapacity of nature to refer itself to God in its integrity.

The absence of God was thus felt deeply in the person's ecstatic nature as the abyss of nothingness, and man could not fulfill his drive for presence except tragically in and through absence.

[48] Christopher G. Woznicki, T. F. Torrance's Christological Anthropology, 2022, 91.
[49] Communion and Otherness, 2006, 237.

The ultimate meaning of the fall was, therefore, in the fact that by perverting personhood (personhood being the only way of communion with God) man turned the difference between uncreated and created natures into a division between the two, and thus ruined God's purpose in creating man: communion.

If we follow this point of division of natures and combine it with the introversion of human personhood, Christology acquires the significance of the event in which the division of natures (divine and human or created) becomes difference, and this happens exactly as it was meant to happen by the creation of man, namely through opening up personhood — and through it creation as a whole — to communion with God. This explains the sensitivity of the early Church to the question of the full unity of two natures in Christ as well as to the integrity of these natures. The anthropological significance of Christology, therefore, contains the following elements in connection with what has already been said about personhood.

Human nature in Christ recovers its ecstatic movement towards God and thus it overcomes its individualization. In this sense, creature-hood becomes a 'new creation' in Christ, that is, a nature which can have a hypostatic universality in its reference to being. This leads to a full realization of the priestly character of humanity: humanity can now, in Christ, recapitulate and 'refer back' (anaphora) nature to its creator.

Hence, the importance of Christ in this respect is that personhood is now objectively restored not on the level of an individual but on the level of true personhood which is capable of bearing human nature in its catholicity. Had Christ been another 'individual' among us, this wholeness of nature would not have been realized. The exclusion of the extreme Antiochene view of an individual human subject in Christology appears to be essential in this respect.

Human nature now becomes able to turn God's absence in creation into presence. Christology reveals its relevance for humanity only if what has been said here earlier about human capacity for presence-in-absence is made the context of the Incarnation.

“Jesus Christ is the one in whom the true humanity is perfectly realized”[50]

WEEK SEVEN – MID-EXAM

[50] WCC, Christian Perspective on Theological Anthropology: A Faith and Order Study Document, No. 199, 2005, 51.

PART TWO

Week Eight

Theology of the Image in Patristic Taught

The theme of the "image" has a long history. It lies at the heart of the anthropology of the Old Testament, especially in the book of Genesis and in the Wisdom literature. “For God created man for immortality and made him an image of His own eternity” (Wis. 2:23).

For wisdom moves from one place to another
More easily than motion itself,
And because of her purity, she penetrates all things
So she is the exaltation of the power of God
And the examination of the pure glory of the almighty
Therefore nothing defiled enters her
For she is the radians of eternal light
A spotless mirror of the operative power of God
And the image of his Goodness … (Wis. 7:24 - 28).

This passage illustrates the divine attributes of Christ, who is the image of the invisible God.[51] One may also recognize here many of the qualities of the church sees in the Holy Virgin Mary, who bore God the Son in Her womb. From these verses we are reminded that through deification or becoming like God, humanity is given the capacity to share in the uncreated energies of God – His power, purity, light and goodness.[52]

[51] “He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation.” (Col 1:15).
[52] The Orthodox Study Bible, 2008, 901.

According to Genesis 1, God created Adam. Adam here refers not only to a single man named Adam but also to humanity as a whole. This can be taken as antinomy with individualism[53], personal freedom and autonomy[54].[55]

The "image" theme serves as an axis around which not only Orthodox cosmology but also Orthodox anthropology and Christology itself are organized.[56] As we have discussed earlier the Image is the imprinted quality of the soul which differentiate man from the rest of earthly creations. This concept stands against philosophy that sees man as a "little cosmos".[57] If man contains within himself all the elements of which the universe is composed, it is not in this that his true perfection his claim to glory lies.[58]

In the New Testament the term is further enriched with Christological content, a fact which endows anthropology with new dimensions. For St. Paul the "Image of the invisible God"[59] is Christ, and man is image of the Image.[60]

All the Fathers of the Church, both of East and of West, are agreed in seeing a certain co-ordination, a primordial correspondence between the being of man and the being of God in fact of the creation of man in the Image and Likeness of God.

The image of God is sought in the sovereign dignity of man, in his lordship over the terrestrial world; sometimes it is sought in his spiritual nature, in the soul, or in the principle, ruling part of his being, in the mind, in the higher faculties such as the intellect, the reason, or in the freedom

[53] Individualism is a social and political philosophy that emphasizes the moral worth of the individual. It advocates for personal freedom, self-reliance, and the pursuit of individual goals and desires. This ideology prioritizes the rights and responsibilities of individuals over those of the collective or society as a whole.

[54] Personal Autonomy: Individuals have the right to make their own choices and decisions without undue influence or control from others.

[55] John F. Kilner, Dignity and Destiny: Humanity in the Image of God, 2015, 85.

[56] Panayiotis Nellas, Deification in Christ: The Nature of the Human Person, 1987, 22.

[57] Microcosm and Macrocosm: This principle posits that the human being (microcosm) is a smaller version of the universe (macrocosm). Just as the cosmos is made up of various interconnected elements, humans are composed of body, mind, and spirit, or earth, water, air and fire all intricately linked.

[58] Vladimir Lossky, The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Orthodox Church, 112.

[59] This theological theme is Trinitarian in nature. St. Basil the Great affirms the Son's divinity by using the theme of the Image of God. The Son is the living Image of the invisible God. This means that the Son, as an Image of God, has the same essence as God. Because He is the perfect Image of the Father, He reflects not only the "Magnificent attributes" of the essence of the Father, but the very essence itself. (Maximos Aghiorgoussis, In the Image of God, 1999, 49-50)

[60] Panayiotis Nellas, Deification in Christ: The Nature of the Human Person, 1987, 23.

proper to man, the faculty of inner determination, by virtue of which man is the true author of his actions.[61] The number of these definitions and their variety show us that the Fathers refrain from confining the image of God to anyone part of man.

"Image refers to the matter of control, not anything else, in other words, God created the human being as having control of everything on earth, and nothing on earth is greater than the human being, under whose authority everything falls."[62]

St. Macarius of Egypt, in Homilies attributed to him says "the image of God is presented in two ways. First it is the formal condition of liberty, free will, and the faculty of choice which cannot be destroyed by sin; secondly, it is the 'heavenly image', the positive content of the image, which is that communion with God, whereby before 'the fall man was clothed with the Word and the Holy Spirit.

St. Irenaeus, St. Gregory of Nyssa, and St. Gregory Palamas, not only the soul, but also the body of man shares in the character of the image, being created in the image of God. 'The word Man is not applied to either soul or body separately, but to both together, since together they have been created in the image of God.'[63]

The theme of the Image of God finds various **applications** in theology of St. Basil the great. Among these applications are in the domain of Trinitarian Theology, angelology, anthropology, Christology, ecclesiology, and finally eschatology.[64]

WEEK NINE

"Eikon Theou" in Cappadocian Fathers

This session will be covered in reading assignment on:

- Maximos Aghiorgoussis, "In the Image of God"
- Vladimir Lossky, "The Mystical Theology of The Eastern Church" (Chapter Six)

[61] ግርማ ባቱ፣ የነገረ መለኮት መግቢያ፣ 2015 ዓ.ም.፣ 207-222.
[62] The Fathers of the Church, St. John Chrysostom: Homily I-17 (Homily 8), 1986, 110.
[63] Vladimir Lossky, The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Orthodox Church, 114-115.
[64] Maximos Aghiorgoussis, In the Image of God, 1999, 49-50.

- _____, "In the Image and Likeness of God" (Chapter Seven, The Theology of the Image)

WEEK TEN

Purpose of the Human being in Theology

Theosis: the true purpose of Human Life

> For what purpose are we placed on earth? If man takes a correct stance on this issue; if he finds his true destiny; then he will be able to take a correct viewpoint in relation to particular questions that arise in our daily life; in our relationships with our fellow men; in our studies, profession, marriage and the bearing and upbringing of children. If he does not relate correctly to this basic issue, then he will also fail in life's particular purposes, for what meaning can a particular purpose have if human life as a whole has no meaning?[65]

The combination of Image and Likeness serves both as the model for original humanity and as the goal to which they will return.[66] Many commentators have rightly noted that humanity's renewal according to God's image in Christ accomplishes what God originally intended for Adam and Eve in Eden. However, far more than a return to Eden is involved here. God's image is forward-looking by its very nature. It's primarily about God's eternal purposes for humanity – not merely current attributes, whether those like God's or those unlike animals. God's purpose involves much more for humanity than is evident in the initial creation.[67]

Though implicitly, the Holy Bible teaches about theosis. The promise of salvation has been understood as theosis may be found in several scriptural passages, including Gen.1:26-27; Gen. 3: 5; Ps 82:6; Jn. 10:34-35, Mt. 5:48; 2 Cor. 3:18; 2 Pt. 1:4 and 1 Jn. 3:1-2.[68]

The New Testament is more concerned about Christians focusing on becoming conformed to the image of Christ. "for whom He did foreknow, He also did predestinate to be conformed to the image of His Son, that He might be the firstborn among many brethren - ልጁ በብዙ ወንድሞች

[65] George Mantzaridis, Theosis: The True Purpose of Human Life, 2006, 19.
[66] Ben C. Blackwell, Christosis: Pauline Soteriology in Light of Deification in Irenaeus and Cyril of Alexandria, 2011, 40.
[67] John F. Kilner, Dignity and Destiny: Humanity in the Image of God, 2015, 274-276.
[68] Michael J. Christensen and Jeffery A. Wittung, Partakers of the Divine Nature, 2007, 24.

መካከል በኩር ይሆን ዘንድ አስቀድሞ ያወቃቸው **የልጁን መልክ እንዲመስሉ** አስቀድሞ ደግሞ ወስኖአልና" (Rom. 8:29).

Deification or Theosis is a way of expressing a sense of the "plan of the mystery hidden for ages in God who created all things" (Eph. 3:9).[69]

The concept is used repeatedly by St. Paul to direct his disciple Timothy: "And without controversy great is the mystery of godliness: … እግዚአብሔርንም የመምሰል ምሥጢር ያለ ጥርጥር ታላቅ ነው፣ … (1 ጢሞ 3፡16)።

1Tim. 2:1-2

1Tim. 4:7-8

1Tim. 5:4

1 Tim. 6:3-11

Titus 2:12-13

2Pet. 1:2-7, 11, 12

It remains evident enough that the term Theosis itself is not explicitly advanced by scriptures. But, Church Fathers used it to sum up the message and meaning of the Scriptures.

Incarnation and Theosis

ዘአንገሠ ለሥጋ አዳም በመንፈስ ቅዱስ ወረሰዮ ቅዱሰ ወማሕየዌ። ዘለብሶ ለአዳም መዋቲ ወአንሥኢ ወአዕረገ እስከ ሰማያት በሥጋ።[70]

Christ opened the possibility of attaining the fullness of Mystical union with Himself by being perfect Human. If He has no the same substance with the father, (ዘዕሩይ ምስለ አብ በመለኮቱ) as Athanasius said, if he be not truly God (ፍፁም አምላክ), our deification is impossible. This is why Lossky said Theosis is the crown of all theology-theology proper, Soteriology, etc.

St. Irenaeus said "The Word of God was made man and He who was Son of God was made Son of Man united to the Word of God, in order that man should receive adoption and thereby become the Son of God. How else could we have received incorruption?"[71]

[69] Michael J. Christensen and Jeffery A. Wittung, Partakers of the Divine Nature, 2007, 36.

[70] ሃይማኖተ አበው፣ እልመስጦአግያ 2፡5-6።

The statement made by Irenaeus: 'God made himself man, that man might become God', the idea rephrased by St, Athanasius of Alexandria, is very well known.[72]

Lossky explains, "God made Himself Man, that Man might become God- these powerful words which we found for the first time in St. Irenaeus, are again found in the writings of St. Athanasius, St. Gregory of Nazianzus, and St. Gregory of Nyssa.

St. Cyril of Alexandria (377-444) spoke of deification as the supreme goal of created beings. He said, through participation in the body and precious blood of Christ, He is united in us and we to in Him.

St. Ephrem- on divine descent human ascent

"A bird grows up in three stages, from womb to egg, then to the nest where it sings, and once it is fully grown it flies in the air, opening its wings in the symbol of the cross."[73]

These three stages are creation of man, incarnation of the Logos, and His resurrection

"Divinity flew down and descended
to raise and draw up humanity.
The Son has made beautiful the servant's deformity,
and he has become a god, just as he desired."[74]

Cappadocian Fathers

They are probably best understood as the theologians who successfully transformed this largely considered as Alexandrian theology into a universalized Tradition of the church. Both Gregory Nazianzen and Basil wished to re-present Plato as a "door into Christianity." They successfully came up with a distinction between essence and energy of God. St, Basil of Caesarea says "Contemplation is the engine that drives the process of Theosis"

Basically, they wanted to Christianize Plato to help evangelize the educated classes of their day.

St. John Chrysostom says that what a great blessing that we partake of the immaculate Mysteries! Christ becomes ours; Christ's life becomes ours; His blood becomes our blood. God has nothing more to give man than what he gives him in Holy Communion. Neither can man ask for anything beyond what he receives from Christ in Holy Communion.

[71] Against Heresies, book 5.
[72] On the incarnation: 54.
[73] Hymns on faith.
[74] Hymns on paradise, (Translated by Sebastian Brock) 1990: 73.

This way then, having been baptized, chrismated, and having confessed, we commune through the Body and Blood of the Lord, and we too become gods by Grace; we unite with God; we are no longer strangers, but His intimates.[75]

The Role of Holy Virgin Mary

"… As the first human person who achieved Theosis-in an exceptional and, of course unrepeatable way the Lady Theotokos played a role in our salvation which was not only fundamental, but both necessary and irreplaceable"[76]

> "The incarnation was not only the work of the Father, by His power and by His Spirit, but it was also the work of the will and faith of the Virgin. Without the consent of the Immaculate, without the agreement of her faith, the plan was as unrealizable as it would have been without the intervention of the three divine Persons. It was only after having instructed her and persuaded her that God took her for His Mother and borrowed from her the flesh, that She so greatly wished to lend Him. Just as He became incarnate voluntarily, so He wished that His Mother should bear Him freely and with her full consent. **In the person of the Virgin, humanity has given its consent** to the Word becoming flesh and coming to dwell amongst men, for, according to the patristic phrase 'if the Divine will alone was the creator of man, it could not save him without the concord of the human will"[77]

The Holy Virgin Mary has an exemplary role to us on the way to achieve theosis**. "… As the first human person who achieved Theosis-in an exceptional and, of course unrepeatable way the Lady Theotokos played a role in our salvation which was not only fundamental, but both necessary and irreplaceable"[78]**

Means of Theosis: Orthodox Belief/Faith, Sacraments, kenosis/Self Humility, Asceticism, Prayer, Fasting, Spiritual deeds …

The purpose of human life – theosis is a major theme in patristic as we have seen in the examples above. For further discussions and understanding go through the recommended readings in the footnotes. "ዘንተ ተምህርናሁ እመጻሕፍተ መለኮት ወዓዲ ረከብናሁሙ ለምእመናን ሰባሕያን በንባበ መለኮት ይሰመዩ አማልክተ በከመ ይቤ መጽሐፍ አማልክት አንትሙ ወደቂቀ ልዑል ኩልክሙ፣ ዘከመ ግብሩ ለመለኮተ ሥላሴ"[79]

[75] Archimandrite George, Theosis: The True purpose of Human life, 2006: 36.
[76] Archimandrite George, Theosis: The True purpose of Human life, 2006: 31.
[77] Vladimir Lossky, The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Church, 1973, 140.
[78] Archimandrite George, Theosis: The true purpose of Human life, 2006: 31.
[79] ሃ.አ. ዘዲዮናስዮስ፣ 10፡9::

WEEK ELEVEN

Dignity of the Human person in Patristic Thoughts

"Respect for man's "personal Identity" is perhaps the most important ideal of our time. The attempt of contemporary humanism[80] to supplant Christianity in whatever concerns the dignity of man has succeeded in detaching the concept of the person from theology and uniting it with the idea of an autonomous morality or with an existential philosophy which is purely humanistic."[81]
"Alas, the faith in the dignity and uniqueness of man … is a thing of the past – he has become an animal … he who was, according to his old faith, a child of God … Now he is slipping faster and faster away from the center into – what? Into nothingness?" Nietzsche[82]

The doctrine of Human Dignity is significant in two ways:
1. Christian theology has a vital role to play in diagnosing and addressing the manifold ways in which human dignity is threatened in contemporary culture and society. Theology's most important contribution is its ability to situate these various threats within a common frame of reference.
2. The crisis that currently surrounds the very concept of human dignity, and the pressing questions.
Since the end of the 2nd World War the issue of human dignity and rights has become increasingly prominent within public discourse across the globe. It is cited in the documents of the United Nations and in the constitutions of many countries of diverse political compositions.

The Christian Tradition has used the term "dignity" with reference to human beings in many ways. The Image of God reflected in human beings generates a remarkable feature that is not

[80] Humanism is a philosophical and ethical stance that emphasizes the value and agency of human beings, individually and collectively. It stresses the importance of reason, ethics, and justice, and often rejects the supernatural and religious dogma as a basis for morality and decision-making.
[81] John B. Zizioulas, Being as Communion, 1997, 27.
[82] R. Kendall Soulen and Linda Woodhead (eds.) God and Human Dignity, 2006, 8.

present in any other creatures namely, the Human Dignity. But we do not find an explicit definition of the expression "dignity of the Human Person" in international instruments or in national law. Dignity can be defined as "the quality of being worthy or honorable; worthiness, worth, nobleness, excellence" and so on.

Sometimes, we find dignity referring to an individual's distinctive rank in society which contradicts the theological notion of human dignity. For example: **Quality of life theory** is a multidimensional concept that aims to understand and measure the overall well-being of individuals and communities. It encompasses various aspects of life, including physical health, mental health, social relationships, and environmental factors.

The **sanctity of life theory** is a philosophical and ethical concept that asserts the inherent value and inviolability of human life. It is often rooted in religious and moral beliefs that every human life has intrinsic worth and should be protected and respected.

The human person in general is the bedrock of dignity. Every human being is a person, endowed with intellect and will. Among all earthly beings, only a man or a woman is a "person," a conscious and free being and, precisely for this reason, the "center and summit" of all that exists on the earth.[83]

Theophilus of Antioch (late second century) holds that God "first reveals the dignity of man in the act of creation, when He declared 'Let Us make man after our Image and Likeness' and appointed him to have dominion over all earthly things. Almost all Church Fathers taught about human dignity based on the act of creation.

The second major theme in the teachings of Church fathers on human dignity is with respect to God's redemption in Christ and its appropriation through life in the Spirit and the practice of Christian virtue. St. John Chrysostom (C. 347-407) declares that God's calling confers "the greatest mark of dignity," whereby all who are united with Christ are made to be not merely angels and archangels but 'sons of God' and 'beloved'.[84] This great distinction comes to all equally, for "where the nobility of faith is, there is none barbarian, none Grecian, none stranger,

[83] Dr. Linus Neli, Human Dignity and Human Rights: Concepts from Christian and Hindu Traditions, 2014, 24-25.
[84] NPNF, series 1, Vol. 10, p.78 (Homily on Matthew 12:4).

none citizen, but all mount up to one height of dignity.[85] And again he declares "see the dignity of the Church, the angelic condition! No distinction there, neither male nor female."

Nevertheless, Chrysostom also acknowledges that churches fall short of acting in accord with the reality of the church's nature: "I would like to see that the churches were such now!"[86]

A text ascribed to Gregory the wonder maker (c.213-270) shows the divine favor shown to Mary a universal restoration of human dignity, inasmuch as "the human race receives again by thee [Mary] its pristine dignity".[87]

The third context in which early Christian writers spoke of human dignity is with reference to the ultimate goal of human life, which is discussed in the previous session.

ምንትኑ ይከብር እምዝንቱ መዓርግ ወዓይ ምክሕ የዓቢ እምኩሉ ትምክህት ከመ ይንብብ እግዚአብሔር በልሳነ ሊቀ ነቢያቲሁ ወይኩን ስምዐ ከመ ውእቱ ገብሮ ለእጓለ እመሕያው በአርአያሁ ወበአምሳሊሁ.[88]

When we consider these and similar remarks about human dignity in the early Christian tradition, several noteworthy themes stand out. A first and key point is that we believe that human dignity is conferred by God. It is not a self-grounded possession enjoyed apart from relationship to the creator, redeemer, and sanctifier. As St. John Chrysostom writes in a sermon on Philippians, "Humans possess dignity of rational nature, but this comes to them as a gift, not as something they have earned. Hence there is no natural preeminence amongst us, for no good things is naturally our own"[89] Here St. John Chrysostom formulates a rule that Christians apply not only to the good of creation but to that of new creation and consummation as well.

Since human dignity is conferred by God, its measure and norm is to be discovered not in social convention but in God and in the pattern of God's action toward human kind in creation and redemption in Christ. Dignity consists not so much in self-possession as in dispossession, not so much in entering into oneself but in reaching out in love and care to the other.

Discuss on the following themes:

[85] NPNF, Series 1, Vol. 11, p. 347 (Homily on Romans 2)
[86] NPNF, series 1, Vol.11, p.18 (Homilies on Acts 3)
[87] Four Homilies (2.2.) in ANF, Vol. 6, p.61)
[88] ሃይማኖተ አበው ዘቅዱስ ጎርጎርዮስ ዘኑሲስ፣ ም. 36፣ ክፍል 4።
[89] NPNF, series I, vol. 13, p. 213. (Homilies on Philippians 7)

Who identified with the image of God, Male or female, Whites or blacks, Wealthy or poor? The answer seems clear and simple to us but practically, not.

In Gen. 1 Adam refers to humanity as a whole. Contemporary views miss this point if they are located in societies like the united states that emphasize individualism, personal freedom, and autonomy.[90]

WEEK TWELVE

Sacramental or Ecclesial Personhood/Anthropology

The Ecclesiological significance of the person

The eternal survival of the person as a unique, unrepeatable, and free "hypostasis" as loving and being loved, constitutes the essence of salvation, the bringing of the Gospel to man. In the language of the fathers this is called "divinization" (theosis), which means participation not in the *Ousia* or substance of God, but in His personal existence. The goal of salvation is that the personal life which is realized in God should also be realized on the level of human existence.

Consequently, salvation is identified with the realization of personhood in man. But is not "man" a person even without salvation? Is not sufficient for him to be a "Man" in order to be also a person?[91]

Patristic theology is not satisfied with a humanistic interpretation of the person. From this standpoint patristic theology sees man in the light of two "modes of existence." One may be called the **hypostasis of biological existence**, the other, the **hypostasis of ecclesial existence**.

1. The Hypostasis of Biological Existence

This existence is constituted by a human conception and birth. Every man who comes into the world bears his "hypostasis" which is not entirely unrelated to love: he is the product of a communion between two people.

[90] John F. Kilner, Dignity and Destiny: Humanity in the Image of God, 2015, 85
[91] John B. Zizioulas, Being as Communion, 1997, 50.

According to Zizioulas, the body, which is born as a biological hypostasis, behaves like a fortress of an ego, like a new "mask" which hinders the hypostasis from becoming a person, that is, from affirming itself as love and freedom. The body tends towards the person but leads finally to the individual.

The man without the Spirit does not accept the things that come from the Spirit of God, for they are foolishness to him, and he cannot understand them, because they are spiritually discerned.

The spiritual man makes judgments about all things, but he himself is not subject to any man's judgment: (1Cor 2:14 - 15).

"ለፍጥረታዊ ሰው የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ነገር ሞኝነት ነውና አይቀበለውም፤ በመንፈስም የሚመረመር ስለ ሆነ ሊያውቀው አይችልም፤ መንፈሳዊ ሰው ግን ሁሉን ይመረምራል ራሱ ግን በማንም አይመረመርም።" (1 ቆሮንቶስ 2:14-15) ።

2. The Hypostasis of Ecclesial Existence

Sacraments have significant effect in the state of the human person. The hypostasis of ecclesial existence is constituted by the new birth of man by baptism. As the conception and birth of a man constitute his biological hypostasis, so baptism leads to a new mode of existence to regeneration, and consequently to a new hypostasis.

> ኢየሱስ ክርስቶስ ከሙታን በመነሣቱ ለሕያው ተስፋና ለማይጠፋ፣ እድፈትም ለሌለበት፣ ለማያልፍም ርስት እንደ ምሕረቱ ብዛት **ሁለተኛ የወለደን** የጌታችን የኢየሱስ ክርስቶስ አምላክና አባት ይባረክ፤ ይህም ርስት በመጨረሻው ዘመን ይገለጥ ዘንድ ለተዘጋጀ መዳን በእምነት በእግዚአብሔር ኃይል ለተጠበቃችሁ ለእናንተ በሰማይ ቀርቶላችኋል። … **ዳግመኛ የተወለዳችሁት ከሚጠፋ ዘር አይደለም፣** በሕያውና ለዘላለም በሚኖር በእግዚአብሔር ቃል ከማይጠፋ ዘር ነው እንጂ።
> Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, which according to his abundant mercy has begotten us again unto a lively hope by the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, to an inheritance incorruptible, and undefiled, and that faded not away, reserved in heaven for you. Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever (1Pet. 1:3, 23).

This new hypostasis which baptism gives to man (ecclesial) has all the basic characteristics of "authentic personhood". For the new ecclesial hypostasis "father" was not the physical progenitor but He "who is in heaven" and "brothers" were the members of the church.

The Christian through baptism stands over against the world, he exists as a relationship with the world, as a person in a manner free from the relationship created by his biological identity. This

means that henceforth he can love not because the laws of biology oblige him to do so – some – thing which inevitably colors the love of one's own relations – but unconstrained by the natural laws.[92]

By participating in the divine mysteries man can avoid the individualistic ago. Theologically, the difference between baptized and unbaptized people is so massive. But practically, there are many issues to be reexamined as St. Paul did with the Corinthians.

"My brothers and sisters, some from Chloe's household have informed me that there are quarrels among you. What I mean is this: One of you says, "I follow Paul"; another, "I follow Apollos"; another, "I follow Cephas"; still another, "I follow Christ." Is Christ divided? Was Paul crucified for you? Were you baptized in the name of Paul? I thank God that I did not baptize any of you except Crispus and Gaius, so no one can say that you were baptized in my name" (1 Corinthians 1).

"Brothers and sisters, I could not address you as people who live by the Spirit but as people who are still worldly—mere infants in Christ. I gave you milk, not solid food, for you were not yet ready for it. Indeed, you are still not ready. You are still worldly. For since there is jealousy and quarreling among you, are you not worldly? Are you not acting like mere humans? For when one says, "I follow Paul," and another, "I follow Apollos," are you not mere human beings?" (1 Cor. 3:1-3).

- Is tribalism or Racism heresy or not?
- What does the question "Is Christ divided?" imply?

WEEK THIRTEEN

Theo-Anthropological Response to Contemporary Trends

We live in a postmodern world. According to Dr. Paulos Mar Gregorios, our world today is characterized by two mutually related factors: the "Eclipse of God"[93] and "Autonomy of man" theories.

[92] John B. Zizioulas, Being as Communion, 1997, 57. ግርማ ባቱ፣ የነገረ መለኮት መግቢያ፣ 2015 ዓ.ም.፣ 265-282.

- **The eclipse of God Theory**

The "Eclipse of God" theory is a concept introduced by the philosopher Martin Buber in his book *"Eclipse of God: Studies in the Relation between Religion and Philosophy."* Buber uses the metaphor of an eclipse to describe how modern life and thought have obscured our direct relationship with the divine. Here are some of his key points:

Key Concepts

1. **Eclipse Metaphor**: Buber compares the diminishing presence of God in modern life to an eclipse, where something (in this case, our own self-centeredness) blocks our view of the divine.
2. **Loss of Intimacy**: Buber argues that contemporary culture and philosophy have led to a loss of intimacy with God, making it difficult for individuals to experience a direct, personal relationship with the divine.
3. **New Theology**: Buber's theory is associated with the "new theology" of theologians like John Robinson, Harry Williams, and Paul Van Buren, who sought to reinterpret traditional religious concepts in light of modern thought.
4. **Subjectivity**: Buber suggests that the problem lies in our inability to distinguish between our own subjective experiences and the objective reality of God.

The aggregate result of these movements affects man as a relational being and promotes individualism. And today people in the west are forced to think as they are by their own.

- **The autonomy of man theory**

The autonomy of man theory centers on the idea that individuals have the capacity and right to make their own decisions and govern their own lives, free from external control or influence.

[93] There are different way of usage and interpretation of "the eclipse of God" theory. Some derive the concept from the Holy Bible (Deuteronomy 31:17-18) when God says "And I will forsake them [the children of Israel], and I will hide my face from them, and they shall be devoured" Also in Deuteronomy 32:20; Psalms 13:2, 102:3, 143:7; Isaiah 8:15, 40:27, 45:14, 45:15, 57:15, 59:1, 64:10; Job 23:3, 34:29; and Jeremiah 29:10. "እርሱም አለ፦ ፊቴን እሰውርባቸዋለሁ፣ ፍጻሜያቸው ምን እንደሆነ አያለሁ፤ ጠማማ ትውልድ፣ ያልታመኑም ልጆች ናቸውና።" (ዘዳግም 32፡20)

This concept is related with the enlightenment period and deeply rooted in various philosophical, ethical, and political traditions. Here are some key aspects of the autonomy of man theory:

Core Principles

1. **Self-Determination**: Autonomy emphasizes the importance of individuals having the freedom to make choices about their own lives, including their actions, beliefs, and values.
2. **Moral Responsibility**: With autonomy comes the responsibility to act ethically and consider the consequences of one's actions. Autonomous individuals are accountable for their decisions.
3. **Personal Freedom**: Autonomy is often linked to personal freedom, suggesting that people should have the liberty to pursue their own goals and interests without undue interference from others.
4. **Individual Rights**: The theory supports the protection of individual rights, such as freedom of speech, freedom of religion, and the right to privacy, which are essential for personal autonomy.

One way to talk of "the death of God", as an "event which took place in our life time" from which even humanity is to draw the conclusion that man is on his own, and that he must take the responsibility to shape and control reality. This way was first proposed in recent history by Frederich Nietzsche, Jean-Paul Sartre and a few so-called theologians.

A second way for "the eclipse of God", in this way of thinking, is that technology has developed an objectifying tendency on the part of man towards all reality, or the tendency to turn every "Thou" into "it".

What was only personally addressed before has now become an object to manipulate and exploit, as we do with nature today. If God could have been caught in the web of our science, our technology would be there to objectify Him also and enslave Him in order to exploit Him for our own purposes. When God refuses to be caught by our objectifying consciousness, we deny His

existence. It is thus the objectifying consciousness which is so central to science and technology that induced the eclipse of God.

If evolutionary, says Dr. Paulos, and if it is the eclipse of God that is behind the assertion of the autonomy of man, then the most characteristic feature of the Secular age is the eclipse of God. He believes that the idea of the death of God is valid and an explanation for the eclipse of God only in the sense that **what has died is not God, but only our idea of God**. This idea of God, on deeper analysis, turns out to be an idol that has been created by theologians, especially in the West. In that sense the death of this idol is a matter for rejoicing, especially for Christians whose relation to God is not through ideas, but rather through the act of worship and prayer in which God remains a subject and not an object, one who can be addressed, loved and adored, but who cannot be described or conceptualized or comprehended.[94]

Postmodernism poses excess challenges to Christian theology. First, given the postmodernists are claiming that an emphasis on the Bible as propositional revelation is questionable or even errant. They argue that our view of Scripture must be reevaluated. Community should take precedence over doctrinal propositions. Liberal theologians in this perspective say, the formulation of the nature of human being should be through humanistic and social scientific studies apart from human being's being interpreted by any religion by highlighting the freedom of human being to define his or her own religion.

Many of the 20th c. thinkers say humans do not come into the world equipped with anything more than their biological substratum. Their most qualities – their characteristically human qualities-derive instead from culture, from the effects of nurture. The idea the human being as a blank slate, a term going back to John Locke (1632-1704), appealed to the modern to the modern sense of possibility.

A century and half after the publication of Charles Darwin's The Origin of Species, biology has fully returned to nature. In this respect we are no different from all other animals. For so-called socio-biologists, human are city builders for reasons not dissimilar to why bees are hive builders.

"Modern anthropology no longer follows Christian tradition in defining the uniqueness of humanity explicitly in terms of God; rather it defines this uniqueness through reflection on the

[94] The Secular Age, 2003, 13.

place of humanity in nature and specifically through a comparison of human existence with that of the higher animals"[95] Almost all scientific views on man consider the human person in nature, nothing beyond and hidden. These views regard nature as self-sufficient and self-contained unit with its own law.

If we take all into one category, would give us the extent of Darwinian influence which is a mere hypothesis. Today, evidences are frequently coming for the Holy Bible than for evolutionary theory.

In contrast to the evolutionary process thought by atheists, human beings are created with upright form. St. Gregory of Nyssa said: *"But man is upright and extends aloft towards heaven, and looks upwards: and these are marks of sovereignty which show his royal dignity. For the fact that man alone among existing things is such as this, while all others bow their bodies downwards, clearly points to the difference of dignity between those which stoop beneath this sway and that power which rises above them."*[96]

Scientific and hypothetical theories always focus on the things which human beings have in common with other creatures – man as microcosms. But Jürgen Moltmann says "It is only when we become aware of the things which human beings have in common with other creatures and the things that differentiate them, that we can understand what the human being's designation to be the Image of God really means"[97]

Dr. Paulos Mar Gregorios discusses the microcosmic idea based on St. Gregory of Nyssa's teachings. As quoted by him St. Gregory says:

> "How petty and how unworthy of the greatness of man sound the imaginings of some outside philosophers who presume to magnify man by comparing him to the cosmos! For they say that man is a little cosmos being constituted of the same elements as the universe! Those who with such a high sounding name seek to bestow praise on human nature seem to be obvious to the fact that they are thereby dignifying man with the attributes of the gnat and the mouse! For they too are a mixture of the same four elements, since each single existing being, whether great or small, we behold only as participating in a portion of these sensible elements, otherwise they would have no nature. What is so great then, in man's being reckoned an impression and likeness of this world-of the heaven that passes away, of the earth that becomes alienated, or of any the things contained in it, since they too are to pass away with that which contains them?

[95] Wolfhart Pannenberg, Anthropology in Theological Perspective, 1985, 27.
[96] Gregory of Nyssa, On the Making of Man, A Double Volume with Hexaemeron of St. Basil, 2017, 175.
[97] Moltmann, God in Creation: A New Theology of Creation and the Spirit of God (Translated by Margaret Kohl), 1993, 188.

> But what then is the greatness of man, according to the teaching of the church? Certainly not in his likeness to the created cosmos but in his coming to be in the image of the creator's nature."[98]

WEEK FOURTEEN

Summary and Conclusion

The course has shown the place and significance of Theological Anthropology. In this case the two theological approaches and their impact on the destiny of the human person is discussed. The impact of katapahatic approaches in theology goes to the extent of autonomy of man theory with its God-objectifying tendency. Having this as a contemporary challenge Theological response to the trends of the time also attempted.

Theological Anthropology is not a detached subject; rather it has a strong relationship with doctrine of creation, Holy Trinity, Christology, Mariology … eschatology. Image and Likeness of God in man relates these all areas of theology into one. But the atheistic and scientific perspectives on the matter went further and brought many contradicting ideas as discussed in the previous sessions. Beyond the class discussion, many references are recommended for further understanding on theological anthropology in particular and Theology in general. So, students are advised to read the references for their better Orthodox Personality.

[98] Cosmic Man, 1980, 15-16; Vladimir Lossky, The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Church, 1976, 114.

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APPENDIX

GREGORY OF NYSSA:

The 30 major issues concerning the human person in his book "**ON THE MAKING OF MAN**"

1. Wherein is a partial inquiry into the nature of the world, and a more minute exposition of the things which preceded the genesis of man?

2. Why man appeared last, after the creation.

3. That the nature of man is more precious than all the visible creation.

4. That the construction of man throughout signifies his ruling power.

5. That man is a likeness of the Divine sovereignty.

6. An examination of the kindred of mind to nature: wherein by way of digression is refuted the doctrine of the Anomoeans.

7. Why man is destitute of natural weapons and covering.

8. Why man's form is upright, and that hands were given him because of reason; wherein also is a speculation on the difference of souls.

9. That the form of man was framed to serve as an instrument for the use of reason.

10. That the mind works by means of the senses.

11. That the nature of mind is invisible.

12. An examination of the question where the ruling principle is to be considered to reside; wherein also is a discussion of tears and laughter, and a physiological speculation as to the interrelation of matter, nature, and mind.

13. A rationale of sleep, of yawning, and of dreams.

14. That the mind is not in a part of the body; wherein also is a distinction of the movements of the body and of the soul.

15. That the soul proper, in fact and name is the rational soul, while the others are called so equivocally: wherein also is this statement, that the power of the mind extends throughout the whole body in fitting contact with every part.

16. A contemplation of the Divine utterance which said,—"Let us make man after our image and likeness;" wherein is examined what is the definition of the image, and how the passible and mortal is like to the Blessed and Impassible, and how in the image there are male and female, seeing these are not in the Prototype.

17. What we must answer to those who raise the question—"If procreation is after sin, how would souls have come into being if the first of mankind had remained sinless?"

18. That our irrational passions have their rise from kindred with irrational nature.

19. To those who say that the enjoyment of the good things we look for will again consist in meat and drink, because it is written that by these means man at first lived in Paradise.

20. What was the life in Paradise, and what was the forbidden tree.

21. That the resurrection is looked for as a consequence, not so much from the declaration of Scripture as from the very necessity of things.

22. To those who say, "If the resurrection is a thing excellent and good, how is it that it has not happened already, but is hoped for in some periods of time?"

23. That he who confesses the beginning of the world's existence must necessarily agree also as to its end.

24. An argument against those who say that matter is co-eternal with God.

25. How one even of those who are without may be brought to believe the Scripture when teaching of the resurrection.

26. That the resurrection is not beyond probability.

27. That it is possible, when the human body is dissolved into the elements of the universe, that each should have his own body restored from the common source.

28. To those who say that souls existed before bodies, or that bodies were formed before souls: wherein there is also a refutation of the fables concerning transmigrations of souls.

29. An establishment of the doctrine that the cause of existence of soul and body is one and the same.

30. A brief consideration of the construction of our bodies from a medical point of view.